Fuel minerals make up the bulk of the output value of metals and minerals. In 2018–19, their output value was Rs 3.96 lakh crore, making up 58 per cent. Coal output value was Rs 1.36 lakh crore and that of petroleum and natural gas Rs 2.59 lakh crore.

The value of output of metallic minerals in 2018–19 was Rs 1.29 lakh crore. The largest contribution came from iron ore with output value of Rs 76,992 crore. Gold output contributed a niggardly Rs 1358 crore, while manganese ore and bauxite contributed Rs 6245 crore and Rs 4844 crore, respectively.

Minor minerals collectively, which include granite, marble and many others, contributed an output value of Rs 1.33 lakh crore and non-metallic minerals Rs 28,026 lakh crore, the bulk of which was limestone with an output value of Rs 22,468 crore.

India’s oil and gas production has been declining for years now, increasing our dependence on imports. Coal production also seems to have reached its peak. In times to come, the paucity of fuel minerals that have been primary contributors to the sector’s GVA might further reduce the share of mining and quarrying in India’s GDP.

Manufacturing Sector Refuses to Leapfrog

There is almost universal long-term consensus since Independence that the growth of manufacturing is necessary to spur growth and employment in India. The teeming millions unproductively employed in agriculture need to switch over to manufacturing for employment and, in turn, lead to manufacturing contributing at least a quarter of India’s GDP. However, the performance of the manufacturing sector has mostly belied this expectation.

In 2018–19, GVA by the manufacturing sector was Rs 27.67 lakh crore. This contributed 16.1 per cent to India’s total GVA of Rs 171.4 lakh crore. In the eight years since 2011–12, this share has been 17.4 per cent, 17.09 per cent, 16.53 per cent, 16.32 per cent, 17.07 per cent, 16.71 per cent,